

This is officially the 22nd Digit Zero1 Awards, something we started in 2001 as a way to hero the best-performing products in multiple categories. We started this off back then in order to hero devices that were heavily R&D driven, that were pushing the boundaries of performance, because, let's face it, if we can afford it, all of us want to buy the absolute best of the best.

The Digit Zero1 Awards was the challenge laid down to our Test Centre and to all of the hundreds of reviewers who have worked for us over the past 22 years... it was the end goal we all had in mind every time we tested a new product, and every time we added on a new product category to test. The Digit Zero1 Awards are the reason why Digit has the most comprehensive testing methodologies for the most product categories tested by a media house across the country! We have to test more thoroughly and more comprehensively, because at the highest end of every category, the difference between competing products can often narrow down to a sliver. At the high-performance end of the market, many other 'reviewers' will end up offering opinions instead of facts and rely on subjective scoring instead of objective testing because their test processes just aren't as detailed and rigorous as ours.

We do have one small problem with the annual schedule though; we cannot consider products that are launched between November 15th and December 31st of a calendar year for that year's Zero1 Awards.

Those products get considered for the next year's awards instead. There is also a slight difference between how we score all products. While normally the tested score you see in the magazine and on the website includes considerations of features and value for money along with performance, for the Zero1 Awards we do not consider either features or value for money, because the awards are given to the Best Performing Products of the Year.

The product that wins the Digit Zero1 Award in a category in 2022 will be held up as the defining product of that year, and it will be what we pit all products that come the next year against. For example, we use the winner of the Digit Zero1 Award 2022 for Best Gaming Laptop to measure the performance increase of the 2023 winner, and thus know how far the industry has improved in performance terms. As hard as we try, we may not be able to test all products launched in a category, we are human and need sleep, you know! For the Best Buy Award that accompanies the Digit Zero1 Award, we go back to considering value for money, or performance-to-price ratios to arrive at which product is the "Best Buy" in a category.

Sadly, since space in the magazine is limited, we can't carry the results of every category we test. You can find any that have been omitted from the magazine at: <https://www.digit.in/zero1-awards/>

Now let's dive straight into seeing how the gadgets we all love hold up against our tests! Let's celebrate the winners of the Digit Zero1 Awards 2022. **d**

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